

essential.

The framework's core message is clear: critical minerals are not merely economic assets but instruments for inclusive growth, local beneficiation, and climate justice. If governed equitably, these value chains can create millions of green jobs, generate public revenue, and catalyse investment in infrastructure, education, and health systems across the Global South.

But this requires a fundamental mindshift, from extraction to empowerment. Africa must move beyond being the world's quarry toward becoming a manufacturing and innovation hub in its own right.

From extraction to equity

The scramble for critical minerals mirrors the colonial extractive rush of the 19th century, yet the stakes today are existential. The choices made in the next decade will determine whether Africa becomes a passive supplier of the green revolution or its co-architect.

Investing in sustainable mining, transparent governance, and regional value chains is not just good policy; , it is Africa's path to industrial sovereignty. The continent holds the keys to the world's green transition. What remains is to ensure that this time, those keys unlock Africa's own prosperity first.

